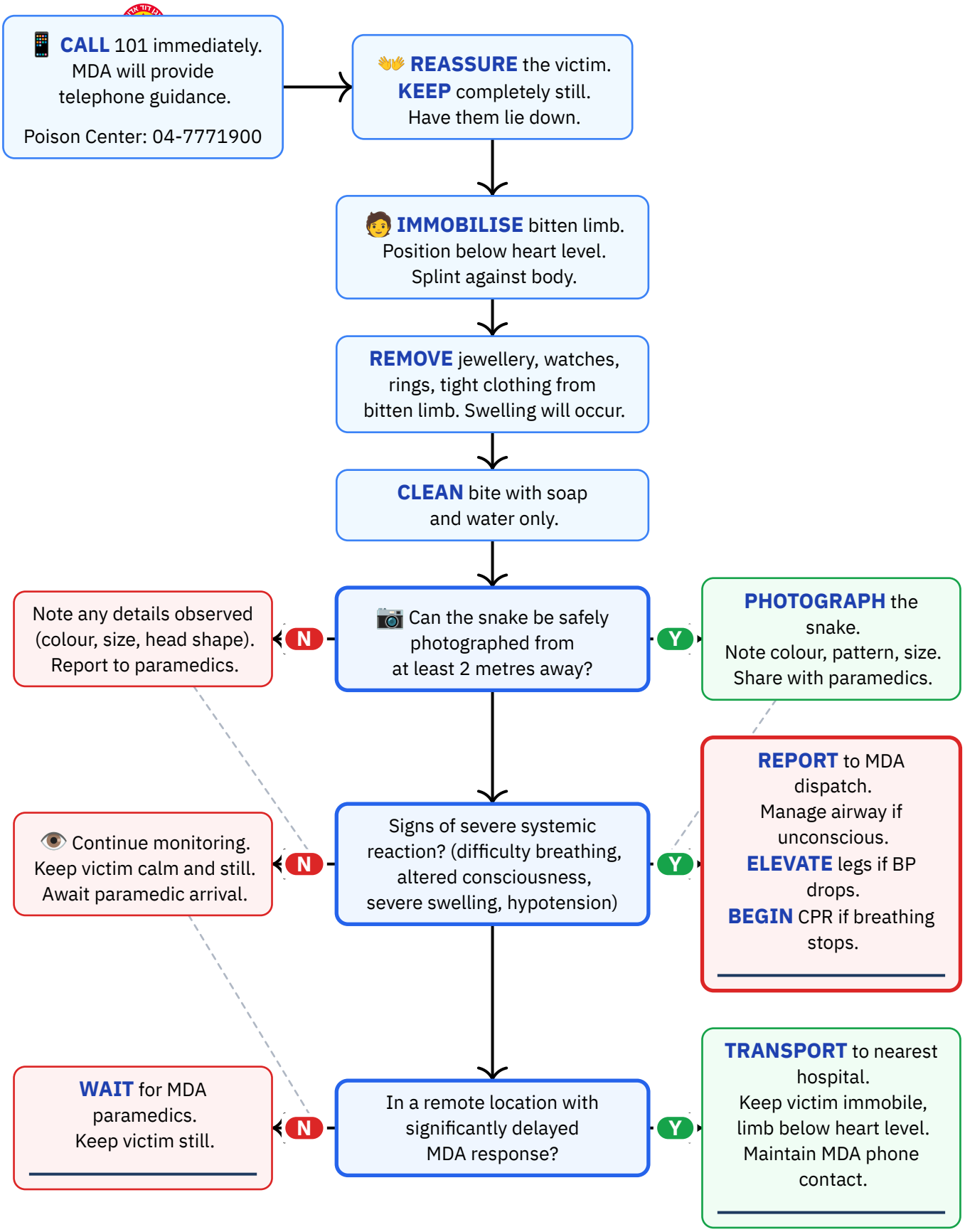




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# Reference Notes

## DO NOT:

- ✕ **Do NOT apply a tourniquet** – it traps venom locally and causes severe tissue damage.
- ✕ **Do NOT suck the venom** out of the wound – this is ineffective and dangerous.
- ✕ **Do NOT cut or incise** the bite area – increases infection risk and does not help remove venom.
- ✕ **Do NOT cool or apply ice** to the bite area – can worsen tissue damage.
- ✕ **Do NOT give food or drink** – may complicate hospital treatment.
- ✕ **Do NOT induce vomiting.**
- ✕ **Do NOT give aspirin, ibuprofen, or naproxen** – viper venom is often anticoagulant.
- ✕ **Do NOT use alcohol-based disinfectants** on the wound.
- ✕ **Do NOT attempt to catch or kill the snake** – protected under Israeli law; risks additional bites.
- ✕ **Do NOT allow the victim to walk** or move the bitten limb – movement accelerates venom circulation.

## Equipment needed:

— Splint or improvised immobilisation material
— Soap and clean water for wound cleaning
— Phone or camera to photograph the snake

## Medically Dangerous Snakes in Israel

| Species | Hebrew Name | Antivenom |
|---|---|---|
| Daboia palaestinae (Palestine viper) | צפע ארצישראלי | Available (Kamada Ltd.) |
| Echis coloratus (Painted saw-scaled viper) | אפעה צבעונית | Available (Kamada Ltd.) |
| Atractaspis engaddensis (Israeli mole viper) | שחור עין גדי | Not available |

Peak season: spring/summer. Israel Poison Information Center: 04-7771900 (24/7, Rambam Hospital, Haifa)


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## Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

| English | עברית | Pronunciation |
|---|---|---|
| Snake | נחש | na-KHASH |
| Snakebite | הכשת נחש | ha-ka-SHAT na-KHASH |
| Venom / poison | ארס | E-res |
| Swelling | נפיחות | ne-fi-KHUT |
| Splint | סד | SAD |
| Lie down | לשכב | lish-KAV |
| Calm down | להירגע | le-hi-ra-GE-a |
| Ambulance | אמבולנס | am-bu-LANS |
| Emergency | חירום | khe-RUM |
| I was bitten by a snake | ננשכתי על ידי נחש | ni-SHAKH-ti al ye-DEI na-KHASH |

**Source:** Magen David Adom (MDA) — How to Treat a Snake Bite
**URL:** https://www.mdais.org/101/snake-bite
**Publication date:** Standing public guidance
**Imported:** 2026-03-15 · **Last verified:** 2026-03-15


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